Asking for opinion	How do you react to this…? Any comments? Could I have your suggestion? What do you think / feel about…? What's your opinion on…?
Checking that they understand	Have I made myself clear? Do you understand what I mean? Get it?
Persuading	How can I persuade you? It will be a misfortune if you cannot… I leave it to your sense…
Rephrasing	In other words… To put it in other words… What I mean is… That's to say…
Giving yourself time to think	Er. Let me see… Well, you see/you know… Well, how shall I put it… Just a minute…
Changing the subject	Oh, by the way… Incidentally… Oh, before I forget…
Avoiding giving an opinion	Well, it's difficult to say… Well, I don't know really… I'd rather not say anything… It all depends…
Introducing a story/anecdote	Here is an interesting story…
Enumeration	My first point is… In the first place… Secondly… Further… In addition…

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